

Use Fedena to Manage Your School



Fedena is an open source tool developed by Bengaluru-based Foradian Technologies that can automate the tasks of managing a school. This article covers its features, with detailed installation instructions.

A number of open source software and tools are available for many of our day-to-day tasks, and they are on par with their commercial counterparts in terms of features and efficiency. If smartly harnessed, the open source revolution can quite brilliantly serve almost every need of yours. I encountered this awesome open source school management software when I was looking for some open source automation tools—I couldn't resist a test drive. At first, it seems a lot of work to find and evaluate a tool, but if the tool is as impressive as Fedena, it's not a bad deal to invest a few hours investigating it, even if it means skipping a few cups of coffee. If you run or manage a school, then this tool can do a lot for you in easing the burden of administration.

So now it's time to see Fedena in action. I installed it on a Windows 7 machine. You can find installation instructions at Fedena's website, <http://projectfedena.org/>, but a few steps are missing, so I'll suggest an installation procedure to make your life a bit easier. It would be unfair if I didn't thank the dedicated Fedena community, which assisted me in figuring out these missing steps.

Fedena is based on Ruby on Rails, so you'll have to install Ruby. Download it from <http://rubyforge.org/frs/download>.

[php/72085/rubyinstaller-1.8.7-p302.exe](#) and run the installer. Now click the Windows icon and click *Start Command Prompt with Ruby*. In this prompt, issue the command `gem install bundler -remote`. Next, run `gem install win32-open3`.

Next, install MySQL—get the required package from <http://downloads.mysql.com/archives/mysql-5.0/mysql-essential-5.0.90-win32.msi> and run the installer. Copy `C:\Program Files\MySQL\MySQL Server 5.0\bin\libmysql.dll` to `C:\Ruby187\bin` and restart the MySQL service.

Download Fedena from <http://projectfedena.org/download/fedena-bundle-win> and extract it. (I extracted it to the C drive.) You'll get a directory called `release`. Run `cd c:\release` to go to the Fedena source directory (modify it if it's different on your system). Run `bundle install -local`. Open `C:\release\config\database` and under the development line, just update your MySQL username and password.

Then run `bundle exec rake db:create` to create the database; `bundle exec rake db:migrate` to populate the database with data; and `bundle exec mongrel_rails start` to start the mongrel server.

Now Fedena should be successfully installed and it's time to launch your browser and visit `127.0.0.1:3000`. You will